

C802

Foundations in Healthcare Information Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A patient uses an app she controls to track her blood pressure and upload records from three different doctors. Her doctors work in a large group practice with a new website. What type of record is her app?

- A. The practice's legal health record.
- B. An electronic medical record (EMR).
- C. A personal health record (PHR).
- D. An electronic health record (EHR).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which record is created by one provider organization and is not built to be shared across organizations?

- A. PHR.
- B. EMR.
- C. EHR.
- D. A health information exchange (HIE).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 200-bed hospital that recently hired a new CEO tracks when patients are admitted, moved between units, and discharged, so the bed board stays current. Which system does this?

- A. Electronic medication administration record (eMAR).
- B. Computerized provider order entry (CPOE).
- C. An executive dashboard for the new CEO.
- D. Admission-discharge-transfer (ADT) system.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

At an outpatient surgery center that recently expanded its parking lot, many claims are denied because the insurance on file had expired before the visit. Coding accuracy is 98%. Which part of the revenue cycle should be fixed first?

- A. Coding.
- B. Registration: verify insurance eligibility before the visit.
- C. Claim submission timing.
- D. Appeals after each denial.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

At a hospital with a busy maternity wing, an audit finds that discharge summaries are complete and accurate but are signed an average of 21 days after discharge. Which data quality characteristic is failing?

- A. Validity, because every late document is invalid.
- B. Completeness.
- C. Accuracy.
- D. Timeliness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A physician at an outpatient clinic with an award-winning lobby performs an office visit and a minor skin biopsy. Which code set describes the procedure on the professional claim?

- A. ICD-10-CM.
- B. CPT.
- C. ICD-10-PCS.
- D. A DRG.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A coder is assigning procedure codes for surgery performed during a hospital inpatient stay, for the facility claim. Which code set applies?

- A.** CPT.
- B.** HCPCS Level II.
- C.** ICD-10-PCS.
- D.** ICD-10-CM.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A clinic is comparing EHR vendors over a 5-year horizon. Vendor A charges a \$200,000 license, \$80,000 for implementation, and \$30,000 a year for maintenance. Vendor A's sales rep offered a free lunch for staff. What is Vendor A's 5-year total cost of ownership?

- A.** \$430,000
- B.** \$280,000
- C.** \$200,000
- D.** \$310,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A system's 4-year TCO is \$500,000, including \$180,000 in up-front costs. The rest is equal yearly maintenance. What is the annual maintenance cost?

- A.** \$125,000
- B.** \$45,000
- C.** \$170,000
- D.** \$80,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A patient asks why her new lab results appeared in the patient portal before her doctor called. The health system has 3 hospitals and a new brand color. Under 21st Century Cures Act information-blocking rules, what is the general expectation?

- A.** Results should be released without unnecessary delay unless a specific exception, such as preventing harm, applies.
- B.** Portals fall only under HIPAA, so timing is up to each hospital.
- C.** Results must always be held until the ordering physician calls.
- D.** Only results from outside labs must be released promptly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A hospital's MPI shows two records, "Ana R. Diaz, DOB 04/12/1980" and "Ana Diaz, DOB 04/12/1980," with the same address. The hospital recently opened a café. What should HIM do?

- A.** Delete the newer record.
- B.** Automatically merge any records that share a last name.
- C.** Investigate as a likely duplicate and merge per MPI procedures if confirmed.
- D.** Leave both, since duplicates cause no harm.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

What is an overlay in a master patient index?

- A.** One patient's information recorded in another patient's record.
- B.** Two records for the same patient.
- C.** One patient with different record numbers at two facilities.
- D.** Any record with a missing date of birth.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A patient uses an app she controls to track her blood pressure and upload records from three different doctors. Her doctors work in a large group practice ~~with a new website~~. What type of record is her app?

Target word: record type **Decides:** The patient controls it.

A	Inverted operation	The legal record belongs to the provider, not the patient.
B	Adjacent category	An EMR is one provider organization's chart.
C	Correct	Patient-controlled records are PHRs.
D	Confusion set	EHRs are maintained by providers.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which record is created by one provider organization and is not built to be shared across organizations?

Target word: reverse: description given, name the record **Decides:** Single-organization, not designed for sharing.

A	Adjacent category	Controlled by the patient.
B	Correct	An EMR is a single organization's digital chart.
C	Confusion set	EHRs are designed to share across settings.
D	Inverted operation	An HIE exists to share data, the opposite.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A 200-bed hospital ~~that recently hired a new CEO~~ tracks when patients are admitted, moved between units, and discharged, so the bed board stays current. Which system does this?

Target word: system type **Decides:** Admission, transfer, and discharge events.

A	Adjacent category	eMAR records medication doses.
B	Confusion set	CPOE takes orders.
C	Camouflage	Dashboards summarize data; they do not register movement.
D	Correct	ADT tracks patient movement and bed status.

4. Answer B Concept 3

At an outpatient surgery center ~~that recently expanded its parking lot~~, many claims are denied because the insurance on file had expired before the visit. ~~Coding accuracy is 98%~~. Which part of the revenue cycle should be fixed first?

Target word: step to fix **Decides:** Coverage was not valid on the date of service.

A	Camouflage	Coding is already accurate and did not cause these denials.
B	Correct	Checking eligibility up front prevents these denials.
C	Adjacent category	Faster submission does not fix expired coverage.
D	Inverted operation	Works at the end of the cycle rather than preventing the problem.

5. Answer D Concept 4

At a hospital with a busy maternity wing, an audit finds that discharge summaries are complete and accurate but are signed an average of 21 days after discharge. Which data quality characteristic is failing?

Target word: quality characteristic **Decides:** Correct and complete, but late.

A	Absolute language	Late documents can still be valid.
B	Adjacent category	The audit found them complete.
C	Confusion set	The audit found them accurate.
D	Correct	Data that arrive late fail timeliness.

6. Answer B Concept 5

A physician at an outpatient clinic with an award-winning lobby performs an office visit and a minor skin biopsy. Which code set describes the procedure on the professional claim?

Target word: code set **Decides:** Outpatient, professional procedure.

A	Adjacent category	Codes diagnoses, not procedures.
B	Correct	CPT codes physician and outpatient procedures.
C	Confusion set	Used for inpatient facility procedures.
D	Dropped element	DRGs group inpatient stays for payment; they are not procedure codes.

7. Answer C Concept 5 · transfer

A coder is assigning procedure codes for surgery performed during a hospital inpatient stay, for the facility claim. Which code set applies?

Target word: reverse: inpatient facility **Decides:** Inpatient facility procedures.

A	Confusion set	CPT is for professional and outpatient services.
B	Adjacent category	Covers supplies and some services, mainly outpatient.
C	Correct	PCS is used for inpatient hospital procedures.
D	Adjacent category	Codes diagnoses.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A clinic is comparing EHR vendors over a 5-year horizon. Vendor A charges a \$200,000 license, \$80,000 for implementation, and \$30,000 a year for maintenance. ~~Vendor A's sales rep offered a free lunch for staff.~~ What is Vendor A's 5-year total cost of ownership?

Target word: 5-year TCO **Decides:** Up-front costs plus five years of maintenance.

A	Correct	$\$200,000 + \$80,000 + (5 \times \$30,000) = \$430,000$.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out maintenance.
C	Confusion set	Purchase price, not total cost of ownership.
D	Wrong stem number	Counts only one year of maintenance.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A system's 4-year TCO is \$500,000, including \$180,000 in up-front costs. The rest is equal yearly maintenance. What is the annual maintenance cost?

Target word: solve for yearly cost **Decides:** $(\$500,000 - \$180,000) \div 4$.

A	Dropped element	Divides the whole TCO by 4 without removing up-front costs.
B	Wrong stem number	Divides the up-front cost by 4.
C	Inverted operation	Adds up-front costs instead of subtracting them.
D	Correct	$\$320,000 \div 4 = \$80,000$.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A patient asks why her new lab results appeared in the patient portal before her doctor called. ~~The health system has 3 hospitals and a new brand color.~~ Under 21st Century Cures Act information-blocking rules, what is the general expectation?

Target word: general rule **Decides:** Information blocking rules favor prompt release.

A	Correct	Holding data without an exception can be information blocking.
B	Confusion set	Cures Act rules also apply.
C	Absolute language	Routine holding can be information blocking.
D	Dropped element	Drops in-house results, which are also covered.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A hospital's MPI shows two records, "Ana R. Diaz, DOB 04/12/1980" and "Ana Diaz, DOB 04/12/1980," with the same address. ~~The hospital recently opened a café.~~ What should HIM do?

Target word: response **Decides:** Likely duplicate records for one patient.

A	Inverted operation	Deleting loses documentation instead of combining it.
B	Absolute language	Risks overlays; matching needs several identifiers.
C	Correct	Duplicates split the history and risk patient safety.
D	Dropped element	Drops the safety risk of a split record.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

What is an overlay in a master patient index?

Target word: reverse: define the error **Decides:** Two patients' data in one record.

A	Correct	That is an overlay.
B	Confusion set	That is a duplicate.
C	Adjacent category	That is an overlap.
D	Dropped element	A completeness gap, not a mixed record.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	EMR vs. EHR vs. PHR	An EMR is one organization's digital chart; an EHR is designed to share across organizations; a PHR is controlled by the patient.	Calling any patient-facing record an EHR.	Who controls it and whether it crosses organizations.
2	Types of health information systems	ADT tracks admissions, transfers, and discharges; CPOE takes provider orders; eMAR records medication administration; CDSS gives decision support.	Mixing clinical and administrative systems.	What event the system records.
3	Revenue cycle front end	Many denials start at registration; verifying eligibility and insurance before service prevents them.	Fixing denials only at the back end.	Denials for expired or wrong coverage.
4	Data quality characteristics	Accuracy, completeness, consistency, and timeliness are separate; late but correct data fail timeliness.	Calling any data problem an accuracy problem.	Correct and complete, but late.
5	Code sets	ICD-10-CM codes diagnoses; ICD-10-PCS codes inpatient facility procedures; CPT/HCPCS code outpatient and professional procedures.	Using ICD-10-PCS for physician office procedures.	Inpatient facility vs. outpatient or professional claim.
6	Total cost of ownership	TCO adds up-front costs (license, implementation) and ongoing costs (maintenance, support) over the planning horizon.	Comparing vendors on purchase price alone.	Multiple cost lines and a number of years.
7	Consumer access and information blocking	Under the 21st Century Cures Act, electronic health information should reach patients without unnecessary delay unless an exception applies.	Assuming results must always wait for a clinician call.	Patients see results in the portal quickly.
8	Master patient index integrity	Duplicates are two records for one patient; overlays put one patient's data in another's record; both need investigation and correction.	Deleting a suspected duplicate or merging on name alone.	Two nearly identical demographic entries.

Course scope (public description): Foundations in Healthcare Information Management applies theories from business, IT, management, medicine, and consumer-centered healthcare skills. Students will learn to evaluate and analyze health information systems for implementation in health information management. There are no prerequisites for this course.